

ORIENTATION LECTURE

The Action Plan

Why It Matters and How to Write One

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KOICA Youth Leadership Program

Public Sector Track · Private Sector Track

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What This Lecture Covers

1

Why the Action Plan Matters

The purpose of the AP, how it fits the KOICA training cycle, and what makes a strong plan.

2

How to Write It

The eight building blocks of an Action Plan, from problem analysis to sustainability.

3

Process & Evaluation

Milestones during the training, the assessment rubric, and common pitfalls to avoid.

Keep a notebook open. Slides 11 to 18 form the template you will actually fill in.

PART ONE

Why the Action Plan Matters

From classroom learning to institutional change in your own country

DEFINITION

What Is an Action Plan?

A concrete, time-bound plan that applies what you learn in Korea to a real problem in your own organisation — written by you, owned by you, and implemented by you after you go home.

- **Real** It addresses a problem that exists in your workplace today, not a hypothetical case.
- **Yours** You are the author and the owner. Not your minister, not your consultant — you.
- **Bounded** It has a defined scope, a schedule, a budget range, and a way to measure success.
- **Implementable** It can realistically start within six to twelve months with resources you can access.

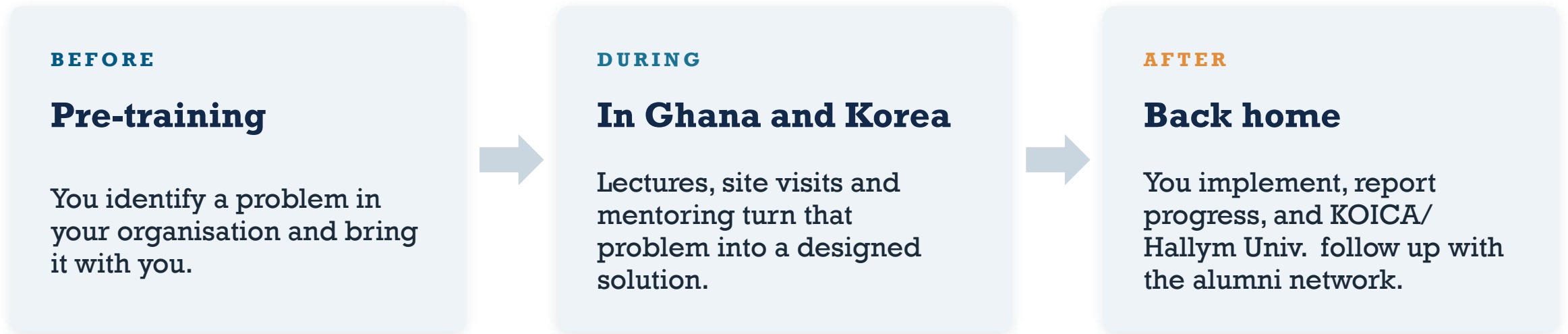
The one-sentence test

If you cannot finish this sentence, your plan is not ready:

“In order to solve **[problem]** affecting **[whom]**, my organisation will **[action]** by **[date]**, measured by **[indicator]**.”

PURPOSE

The Action Plan Is the Bridge



Training that ends at the airport changes nothing. The Action Plan is what converts training period of learning into a change your institution can see.

What an Action Plan Is Not

✗ NOT this

- A summary of the lectures you attended
- A wish list requesting foreign funding
- A national strategy you have no authority over
- A document written the night before the presentation

✓ THIS

- A problem you personally can act on
- Resources you can realistically mobilise
- A scope your position allows you to lead
- A draft refined over the whole training period

Rule of thumb: if implementation depends entirely on someone who is not in this room, narrow the scope.

Two Tracks, Two Types of Deliverable

A. PUBLIC SECTOR

Policy-oriented Action Plan

Governance innovation, digital transformation and youth development systems.

Deliverable: a policy design your agency can adopt

B. PRIVATE SECTOR

MVP Business Plan Draft

AI- and ICT-based solutions to social problems, built as scalable market offerings.

Deliverable: an MVP-level business plan you can pitch

Both tracks use the same eight building blocks. Only the emphasis of the later sections differs.

Three Thematic Areas

1

AI-Based Youth Employment & Skills Development

“AI-Powered Integrated Youth Employment and Vocational Training Matching System”

Labour-market data, skills taxonomies, matching algorithms, TVET linkage.

2

Digital Public Service & E-Government Innovation

“Mobile-Based Digital Public Service Transformation with AI Chatbot-Enabled E-Government System”

Service redesign, mobile-first delivery, chatbot channels, digital identity.

3

Youth Policy Data Governance & Civic-Tech

“Youth Participation-Driven Civic-Tech Data Governance Platform”

Open data, participation mechanisms, data standards, privacy safeguards.

Choose ONE area. You may adapt the suggested title to your country's context — keep the theme.

Three MVP (Minimum Viable Product) Domains

1 Agri Tech

AI-Based Agricultural & Rural Development

“AI-Powered Crop Yield Prediction and Mobile Agricultural Information Service for Smallholder Farmers”

2 FinTech

AI-Based Financial Inclusion Platform

“AI-Driven Microfinance and Credit Scoring Platform for Unbanked Youth Populations”

3 Health / Edu

AI-Based Community Problem-Solving Platform

“Generative AI-Based Community Information Platform for Education and Public Health Services”

MVP means the smallest version that a real user can use and that proves your core assumption — not a full product.
**However, teams that have completed a prototype may write about how they will sell the finished product in the market.*

Five Marks of a Strong Action Plan

S

Specific

One problem, one target group, one geography. Narrow beats broad.

F

Feasible

Achievable with the mandate, staff and budget you actually have.

O

Owned

Your name on it, your unit accountable, your management informed.

M

Measurable

At least three indicators with a baseline and a target value.

A

Aligned

Consistent with national policy and with your organisation's plan.

A small plan that gets implemented outperforms a magnificent plan that sits in a drawer.

PART TWO

How to Write It

The eight building blocks — this is your template

The Eight Building Blocks

1 Background & Context

Where you work, what has changed, why now.

2 Problem Analysis

The core problem, its causes and its effects — with evidence.

3 Objectives

Goal, outcomes and outputs in a single logic chain.

4 Beneficiaries & Stakeholders

Who benefits, who decides, who resists.

5 Activities & Timeline

What will be done, by whom, in which month.

6 Resources & Budget

People, systems, data and money — with sources.

7 Monitoring & Evaluation

Indicators, baselines, targets, means of verification.

8 Risks & Sustainability

What could go wrong, and what keeps it alive after year one.

Write them in this order. Sections 2 and 3 take the most time — and decide the quality of everything after.

Background and Problem Analysis

Block 1 — Background

- Your organisation's mandate and your role
- Relevant national policy or development plan
- What has changed recently — and why now
- What has already been tried, and its result

Keep it to one page.

Reviewers spend most of their time on blocks 2, 3 and 7.

Block 2 — Problem Tree

EFFECTS

Youth unemployment persists; training budgets show low return



CORE PROBLEM

TVET graduates and vacancies are not matched effectively



CAUSES

No shared skills data · manual matching · employers not engaged

Objectives: One Logic Chain

GOAL

Improved youth employment outcomes in the region

Long-term impact you contribute to

OUTCOME

Matching time between graduate and vacancy reduced by 40%

Change in behaviour or performance

OUTPUT

Matching platform live; 5,000 profiles; 300 employers onboarded

What your project directly delivers

Test the chain downwards: if we deliver these outputs, will the outcome plausibly follow? If the outcome happens, does it serve the goal? If the answer is “only with luck”, the chain is broken.

Beneficiaries and Stakeholders

Define your beneficiaries precisely

Who exactly?

Age, sex, occupation, location, income band

How many?

A realistic number for year one, not the whole country

How reached?

Through which office, platform or intermediary

What changes for them?

Stated from their point of view, not yours

Map stakeholders by influence and interest

Keep satisfied

High influence · low interest

Finance ministry, IT authority

Manage closely

High influence · high interest

Your director, partner agency

Monitor

Low influence · low interest

General public, media

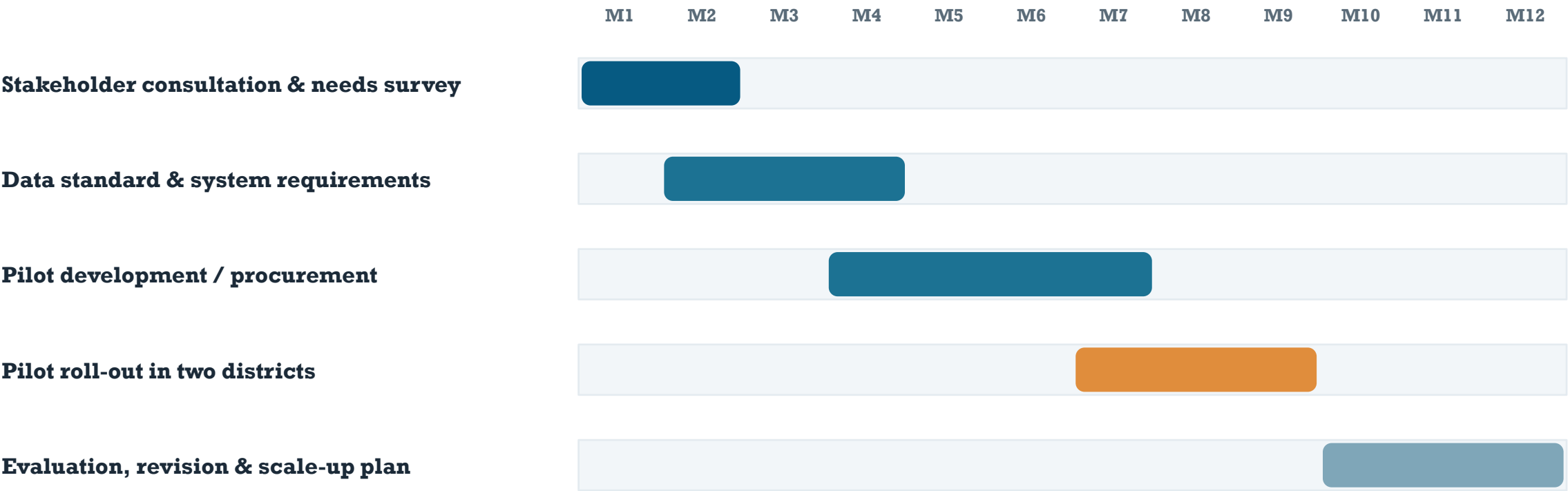
Keep informed

Low influence · high interest

Youth groups, employers, NGOs

Name the person, not the institution. Institutions do not approve budgets — people do.

Activities and Implementation Timeline



For every bar, state three things: the responsible person, the resources required, and the deliverable that proves it is finished.

Resources and Budget

People

Staff time, a project focal point, external expertise

Who releases their time?

Systems & Data

Servers or cloud, software licences, datasets, APIs

Who owns the data you need?

Operations

Training, travel, outreach, translation, help desk

Recurring or one-off?

Contingency

10–15% of total for delay, currency and scope shifts

Reviewers look for this.

Show the funding mix

- Own budget line (existing or requested)
- In-kind: staff, offices, existing systems
- Partners: donor, private sector, university

Estimates are acceptable. Silence is not.

A rough figure with a stated assumption scores far better than a blank budget section.

Monitoring and Evaluation

Indicator	Baseline	Target (M12)	Means of verification	Frequency
Registered graduate profiles	0	5,000	Platform database export	Monthly
Employers actively posting	0	300	Platform admin report	Monthly
Average days to first match	94	56	Platform analytics + survey	Quarterly
User satisfaction (graduates)	n/a	≥ 75%	Annual user survey	Annual

- Mix output indicators (how much you delivered) with outcome indicators (what changed).
- If a baseline does not exist, write “to be established in month 1” — never leave it blank.
- Disaggregate by sex and, where relevant, by district and age group.

Three to five indicators is the right number. Twenty indicators means none of them will be collected.

Risks and Sustainability

Risk register

High

Leadership change

Secure written endorsement in month 1; brief the deputy as well

High

Data unavailable / poor quality

Start with one dataset you already control; MoU for the rest

Medium

Low user uptake

Co-design with 20 users before build; pilot in one district first

Medium

Budget delay

Phase activities so phase 1 fits existing budget

Sustainability: what keeps it alive after year one?

Institutional

Written into a work plan, a regulation or a job description

Financial

A recurring budget line, a fee, or a revenue model — not a one-off grant

Technical

Someone in-house can operate it; documentation and handover exist

Social

Users want it enough to keep using it without being told to

Private sector track: sustainability = your business model. Show unit economics, however rough.

Five Extra Sections for the MVP Business Plan

1

Problem– Solution Fit

Evidence that real users have this problem: interviews, survey data, existing spending.

2

Value Proposition

One sentence: for whom, what pain, what gain, why you rather than the alternative.

3

MVP Scope & Tech

The smallest testable build. Which AI model, which data, which channel, which language.

4

Business Model

Who pays, how much, how often. Customer acquisition cost and unit economics.

5

Traction & Scale

Pilot metrics you will collect in 90 days, and the path from pilot to market.

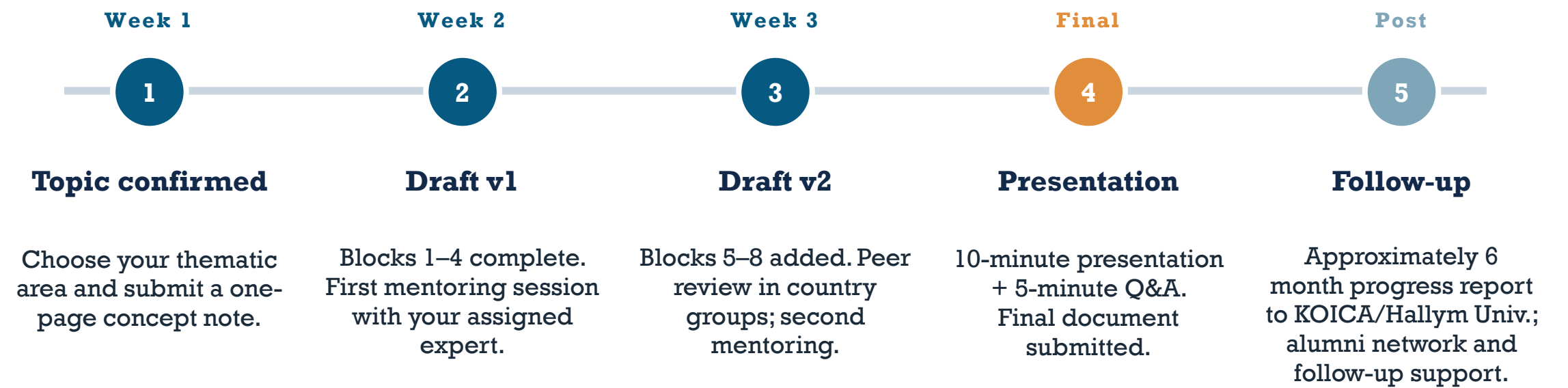
Investors and reviewers ask the same first question: “How do you know anyone wants this?” Answer it on page one.

PART THREE

Process, Evaluation and Pitfalls

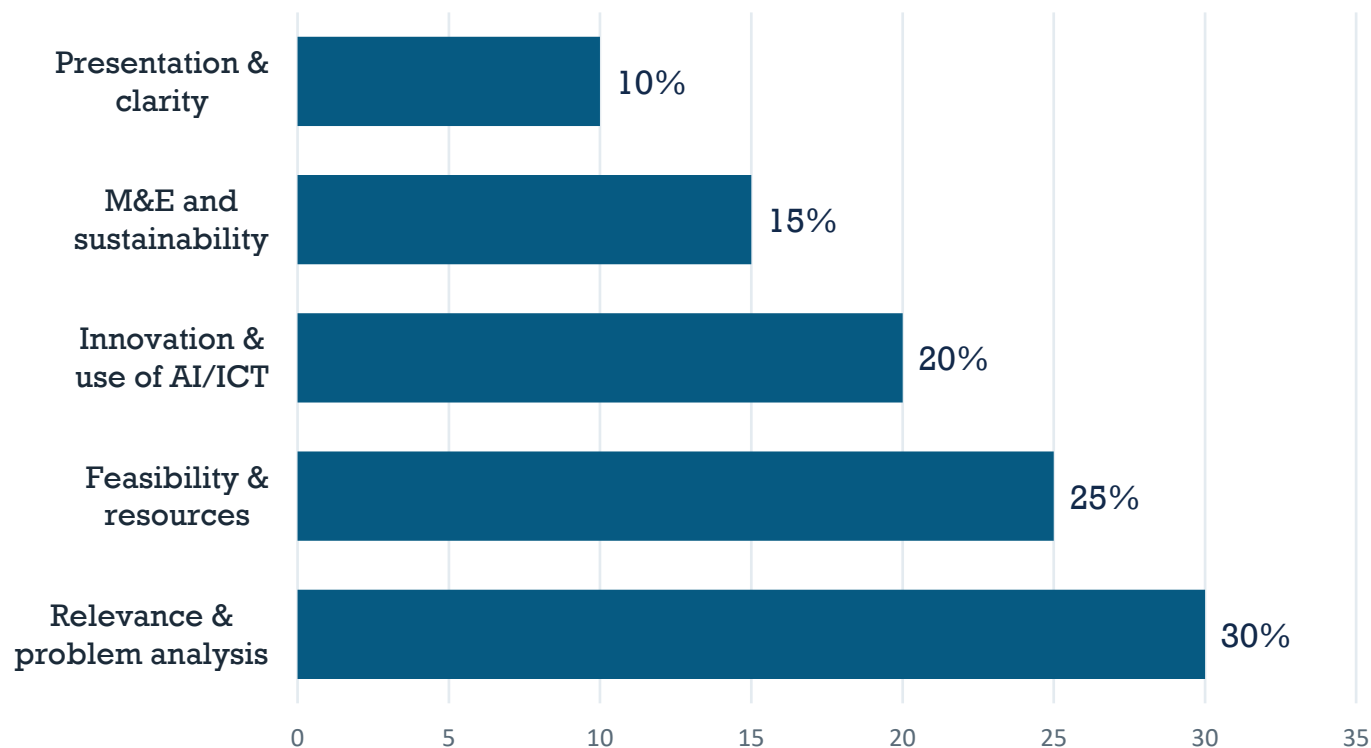
What happens between now and your final presentation

Milestones During the Training



Exact dates are in your programme schedule. Deadlines are firm — mentors are booked by the hour.

How Your Action Plan Is Evaluated



What reviewers reward

- Evidence over adjectives — data with sources
- A scope you can actually start alone
- Honest risks, not a perfect story
- Indicators with real baselines
- A clear answer to “what happens in year two?”

WARNING

Six Pitfalls We See Every Year

✗ **Boiling the ocean**

A plan that would reform an entire sector. Cut the scope until you can start it alone.

✗ **Technology first**

Choosing “AI” before defining the problem. The problem chooses the tool, never the reverse.

✗ **No numbers**

No baseline, no target, no budget figure. Estimate and state your assumption.

✗ **Borrowed plan**

Copying a Korean case without adapting to your law, data and capacity.

✗ **Invisible owner**

Passive sentences with no named person responsible for anything.

✗ **No first step**

Written at the level of principles. Name one action you can start in 6 month.

If you recognise your own draft in two or more of these boxes, rewrite before your first mentoring session.

The Action Plan is not homework.

It is the promise you make to the people you serve



***Thank you
and we look forward to reading your plan.***